

Commissioner's Guide

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Everything the Commissioner needs to run the Peak Dragon Fantasy Football League — from first-time setup through the draft, the regular season, transactions, and the playoffs. It's organised in the order you'll actually use it across a season, with a quick-reference map at the end.

You can undo almost anything. The Commissioner can reverse transactions, correct or undo draft picks, re-settle a scored week, and undo a playoff round. If something goes wrong, it's fixable — don't panic.

1. Orientation

Who's who

- **Commissioner** — you. The single administrator who sets everything up and can reverse any action. (A backup Commissioner account can exist with the same powers.)
- **Manager** — a kid who controls one **Team**: drafts players, sets a weekly lineup, and makes trades and pickups.
- **Team** — a Manager's franchise. The league has **4–10 Teams**.
- **Player** — an NFL athlete or team defense that can be drafted and scored.

Signing in and getting around

Go to `/login` and sign in with your Commissioner username and password. The site works on phones and computers.

- The **top nav** (and the bottom tab bar on phones) has the everyday pages: **Home**, **Matchup**, **Standings**, **My Team**, **Playoffs**.

- The **menu drawer** (≡) has everything, including a **Commissioner** section only you can see:

Commissioner menu item	What it's for
Commissioner Tools (/admin)	Create Teams and Manager logins; reset passwords; activate/deactivate/delete Teams and Managers.
Season Control (/admin/season)	Start each week, set scoring and roster shape, set the trade deadline and playoff size.
Draft Setup (/admin/draft)	Configure, order, start, and run the Draft.
Roster Edit (/admin/roster-edit)	Manually move players between Teams / the free-agent pool.
Unmatched Players (/admin/unmatched-players)	Check the player catalog and the latest data sync.

Every Commissioner action shows a confirmation message ("flash") at the top of the page when it succeeds, or a clear error if something's off.

2. Preseason setup

Do these once, before the draft.

2.1 Set the scoring and roster rules — **Season Control**

Open **Season Control**. Two forms define how the league plays:

- **Scoring** — points per passing/rushing/receiving yard, touchdowns, receptions (the league ships with **Half-PPR**), etc. Adjust any value and save.
- **Roster shape** — how many of each position start each week and how big the bench is (defaults: **QB, RB, RB, WR, WR, TE, FLEX, K, DEF** + a 5-player bench). These numbers also set how many rounds the draft runs (starters + bench).

Set these **before** the draft — the roster shape determines draft length, and you don't want to change scoring mid-season.

2.2 Create the Teams — **Commissioner Tools**

Under **Commissioner Tools**, add each Team by name (e.g. "Thunder Lizards"). Team names must be unique.

2.3 Create Manager logins — Commissioner Tools

For each Team, create the Manager's login: pick the Team, enter a **username**, a **display name**, and a **password** (at least **6 characters**). Each Team gets **one** Manager. There's no public sign-up — you provision every account.

Give each kid their username and password. They can change their own display name and password later on **My Profile**.

2.4 Load the players — Unmatched Players

The player catalog fills automatically from a daily sync (see §8). To fill it immediately, whoever manages the hosting runs the player-sync once (§8). Then open **Unmatched Players** to confirm:

- **Total players** is in the thousands (~3,200).
 - The **unmatched** list is short. "Unmatched" means a player isn't linked to the official weekly-stats source yet — usually obscure or just-added players, safe to ignore unless a well-known player you expect to be drafted is on the list.
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3. Running the Draft — Draft Setup

The Draft is a **snake draft** (pick order reverses each round) held in a shared, live draft room. You drive it from **Draft Setup**; Managers pick from **Draft Room** (`/draft`).

3.1 Configure

On **Draft Setup**, set:

- **Pick timer** — seconds each Manager has per pick (15–600).
- **Auto-pick on expiry** — if on, a Manager who runs out of time gets the system's best pick for them; if off, an expired clock just leaves them on the clock.
- **Roster shape** — same slots as Season Control (shown here too for convenience).
- Optional **draft date/time** — display only, so Managers know when to show up.

3.2 Set the order

- **Randomize order** shuffles all active Teams, or
- **drag to reorder** manually.

You can re-order as many times as you like **until you finalize**.

3.3 Finalize, then Start

- **Finalize** locks the order. Managers can now see the order and build their **Queue** (a private ranked wishlist that speeds up their picks and drives auto-pick).
- **Start** makes the Draft **live** and puts the first Team on the clock.

3.4 Running a live Draft

While the Draft is live you have full control from **Draft Setup**:

Control	What it does
Pause / Resume	Freeze the clock for a break; resume banks the time left.
Add time	Give the Team on the clock extra seconds.
Pick on behalf	Make a pick for a Manager who can't (e.g. no internet).
Auto-draft (per Team)	Toggle a Team to pick automatically and instantly on its turn — use when a Manager has left or is absent.
Correct a pick	Swap a wrong pick for the right player.
Undo last	Roll back the most recent pick.
Reset	Wipe the board back to setup (start over).

Tip: if a kid can't make it, turn on **Auto-draft** for their Team and the system drafts a sensible roster for them without holding up everyone else.

3.5 What happens when the Draft finishes

When the last pick is made, the site automatically:

1. Turns each Team's drafted players into its **season Roster**, and
2. **Generates the regular-season schedule** (a round-robin; odd Team counts get byes).

You're now ready to play weeks. **Transactions (add/drop and trades)** open automatically once the Draft is complete.

4. The regular season — the weekly rhythm

Each week follows the same loop. You do one thing (start the week); the data feeds and Managers do the rest.

4.1 Start the week — Season Control

On **Season Control** → **Start a week**, set:

- **Week number** and **season year**.
- **Lineup-lock time** (kickoff) — prefilled to the coming Thursday 8:20pm league time, editable. **Lineups lock at this time** and can't be changed after.

Managers set their **lineup** on **My Team** (`/lineup`) before the lock — one player per required slot. A Team's lineup carries forward week to week if they don't change it. Benched players don't score.

4.2 Scoring happens automatically

Two automated jobs (set up on the hosting — see §8) handle scoring:

- **Live scoring** runs frequently during games and shows **provisional** scores on the **Matchup** page as games unfold. These are not final.
- **Official settlement** runs once a day after the week's games, replaces the provisional numbers with **official** stats, marks the week **final**, and **locks** it. This can occasionally change a result — standings then reflect the settled outcome.

Kickers and Defenses: the official source doesn't publish team-defense points-allowed or kicking, so K and DEF keep their live values through settlement. That's expected, not a bug.

If you ever need to re-settle a specific past week, there's a `settle_week` setting (defaults to "the week before the current one"); normally you never touch it.

4.3 Following along

- **Matchup** (`/scoreboard`) — this week's head-to-head scores.
- **Standings** (`/standings`) — win-loss records, ranked. **Standings count only regular-season games** and freeze once the regular season ends — playoff results never change them.

5. Transactions (pickups & trades)

Transactions are **Manager-driven** and open automatically after the Draft.

- **Add/Drop** — on **Free Agents** (`/players`), a Manager adds an unrostered player and drops one to make room. **First-come, first-served** — no waivers or bidding.
- **Trade** — on **Trades** (`/trades`), one Manager proposes and the other accepts. Both rosters update on acceptance.

What the Commissioner controls

- **Trade deadline** — on **Season Control**, set the week after which trading closes. Leave it **blank** for no deadline.
 - **Reverse any transaction** — on **Activity** (`/transactions`), you can reverse an applied add/drop or trade if it was a mistake or against league rules.
 - **Roster Edit** (`/admin/roster-edit`) — the manual override: move any player to any Team, drop one to free agency, or add a free agent, bypassing the normal rules. Every edit is itself a **reversible** record.
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6. The Playoffs

A single-elimination bracket among the top Teams. Runs on the same weekly scoring machinery as the regular season.

6.1 Before the season ends

On **Season Control**, set **how many Teams make the playoffs** (2 or more, up to the number of Teams).

6.2 Create the bracket

Once the **final regular-season week is settled** (every matchup that week is final), use **Create the playoff bracket** on the Playoffs controls. This:

- **Freezes the standings as seeds** (best record = #1 seed), and
- Opens **Round 1** in the week after the regular season.

If it refuses, the most common reason is that the last regular week isn't fully final yet — let settlement finish first.

6.3 Run each round

For each playoff round, treat it like a normal week: it lives in its own week, so **Start that week** (lineups, lock time), let the crons score and settle it, then **Advance to the next round**. Repeat until the champion is decided.

6.4 Fixing mistakes

- **Undo the last round** — if a score gets corrected after you advanced, roll the bracket back one round and re-advance.
- **Reset** — clear the whole bracket (before any playoff game has been played).

Everyone watches the bracket and the champion on **Playoffs** (</playoffs>).

7. Ongoing Team & account admin — Commissioner Tools

Things that come up mid-season:

Task	How
Reset a forgotten password	Commissioner Tools → reset password for that Manager (min 6 chars).
A kid leaves	Deactivate their Manager and/or Team . Deactivated Teams are excluded from new drafts, schedules, and playoffs, but their history stays intact.
Bring someone back	Reactivate the Manager/Team.
Remove a Team entirely	Delete — but only allowed if the Team has no history (no draft, roster, matchups, or trades). Anything with history must be deactivated instead.

Managers maintain their own display name and password on **My Profile** (</profile>).

8. Data feeds & automation (for whoever runs the hosting)

The site pulls real NFL data from two sources, run by three scheduled jobs ("cron jobs") on the server. These are set up once in the hosting Control Panel.

Job	How often	What it does
Player sync	Daily	Refreshes the player catalog from Sleeper.
Live scoring	Every ~2 min during game windows (Thu/Sun/Mon)	Provisional scores from Sleeper for the current week.
Official settlement	Daily	Final scores from nflverse; marks the week final and locks it.

On this hosting (ICDSoft) the jobs use the PHP 8.3 CLI and the app under `~/private/FFB`, e.g.:

```
/usr/local/bin/php83.cli /home/michaelkhall/private/FFB/cron/live_scores.php
/usr/local/bin/php83.cli /home/michaelkhall/private/FFB/cron/settle_official.php
/usr/local/bin/php83.cli /home/michaelkhall/private/FFB/cron/sync_players.php
```

All three read the settings you manage on **Season Control** (current week, season year, kickoff/lock times) — so you never edit the database directly.

Deploying code updates: `cd ~/private/FFB && git pull` (add `composer install --no-dev --optimize-autoloader` and `php83.cli bin/migrate.php` only when an update adds dependencies or database changes).

9. Test before it counts — the mock season

Before your **live** draft, you can rehearse the entire season — draft, scored weeks, and playoffs — against real historical data, so you see everything working with zero risk to the real league. See [Running a Mock Season](#).

10. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause / fix
Everyone scored 0 for a week	The week wasn't started, or you're pointed at a season with no data yet. Confirm Season Control shows the right week and season year, and that the scoring jobs ran.
A Manager can't edit their lineup	The week is locked (past kickoff). That's by design; use Roster Edit only for genuine corrections.
"Can't create the playoff bracket"	The final regular-season week isn't fully final yet — wait for settlement, then try again.
"Can't delete this Team"	It has league history — deactivate it instead of deleting.
A drafted star shows on Unmatched Players	Their official-stats link is missing; live (Sleeper) scoring still works. Flag it to whoever runs the hosting to reconcile.
Site loads over http:// but not	On a brand-new subdomain the security certificate can lag a day; <code>http://</code> works meanwhile.

Symptom	Likely cause / fix
https://	

11. Quick reference — Commissioner menu

Menu item	Path	Use it to
Commissioner Tools	/admin	Teams, Manager logins, passwords, activate/deactivate/delete
Season Control	/admin/season	Start a week; scoring; roster shape; trade deadline; playoff size
Draft Setup	/admin/draft	Configure, order, start, and run the Draft
Roster Edit	/admin/roster-edit	Manually move players between Teams / free agency
Unmatched Players	/admin/unmatched-players	Player catalog + last sync check
Activity	/transactions	Review and reverse transactions
Playoffs	/playoffs	View the bracket (create/advance from the controls)

The season at a glance

1. **Preseason:** set scoring & roster → create Teams → create Manager logins → load players.
2. **Draft:** configure → order → finalize → start → run it → (rosters + schedule auto-generate).
3. **Each week:** start the week → Managers set lineups → scoring runs live, then settles final.
4. **Anytime:** manage add/drops, trades (with a deadline), reversals, roster fixes.
5. **Playoffs:** set size → create bracket after the last week settles → start & advance each round → champion.